

Anchor High. Assume Abundance.

How to handle "How much is it?"

Session 39 · Monday 22 June 2026 · Marketing Sweet

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01 · THE STRUCTURE

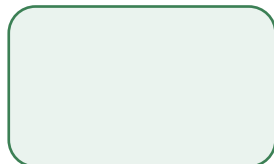
The Three-Number Range

Floor. Ceiling. Likely. In that order.



FLOOR

\$340 / month



LIKELY Level package. Name it. Don't dwell. Buyer knows there's a low entry point.

\$450 – \$650 / month

The actual quote for THIS buyer. Delivered last — after the calibration is done.



CEILING · THE ANCHOR

\$10,000 – \$15,000 / month

Premium tier. Say it confidently. Let it sit in the air for a moment. This is the Platinum Ranger on the showroom floor.

THE ORDER MATTERS

Floor → CEILING → Likely. The ceiling has to land BEFORE the likely number. The buyer needs to see the high anchor before they hear the price they'll actually pay. Reverse the order and the likely number feels expensive instead of reasonable.

USE VERBATIM

"Packages start around \$340. Some clients spend up to \$15,000 a month with us. For your business, I'd allow somewhere between \$450 and \$650. Please don't hold me to that — but that's where I'd sit you at this stage."

02 · THE MENTAL MODEL

Inflate, Then Deflate

The buyer's expectation is a balloon.

STATE 1 · ARRIVAL

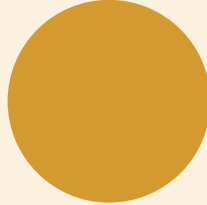
Small balloon



Buyer assumes a low number. Whatever you say next sets the reference.

STATE 2 · INFLATE

"Up to \$15,000"



Balloon stretches. Buyer recalibrates upward. Big number sits in their head.

STATE 3 · DEFLATE

"For you: \$450-650"



Balloon deflates. The \$450 feels REASONABLE because it's sitting next to \$15k.

TWO FAILURE MODES

✗ **Open with the middle number.**

Balloon stays small. The likely price feels expensive — there's no high anchor next to

✗ **Refuse to give any number.**

Balloon inflates on its own to whatever scary figure the buyer's imagination produces

THE NUDGER · "I DON'T THINK IT'S NECESSARY"

After the high anchor, walk the buyer down with this phrase. Signals competence (you've assessed), integrity (you're not upselling for the sake of it), and that you're on the buyer's side — which is where every easier conversation flows from.

USE IT 3+ TIMES PER PRICING CONVERSATION

03 · THE COST OF ASSUMPTION

The Lotus Story

Same wallet. Two completely different sales.

LOTUS DEALER

Saw the tracksuit. Pre-judged.

- ✗ "Pay \$1,000 deposit BEFORE you test-drive — to prove you're serious."
- ✗ Distracted by other conversations
- ✗ Wouldn't answer basic questions
- ✗ Made the buyer feel like an inconvenience

→ **LOST A SIX-FIGURE SALE**

FORD DEALER

Assumed buyer had the money.

- ◆ Matched the buyer's energy on the phone
- ◆ Named the price plainly
- ◆ Took \$500 deposit on the spot
- ◆ Closed in fifteen minutes

→ **SOLD THE CAR**

APPLIED TO THE PHONES

Every prospect call carries the same risk. The rep can't see the buyer's wallet — they're guessing. The guess shapes the whole call before anything price-related is said.

THE TWO REPS

Rep A assumes "can't afford much" → pitches small, loses deals they could've closed. Rep B assumes "has the money" → pitches confidently, wins deals Rep A wouldn't have tried for.

04 · THE DISCIPLINE

Assume Abundance

Default: the buyer has the money and a real problem.

THE TWO ASSUMPTIONS · STATE THEM BEFORE EVERY CALL

- 1. The buyer has plenty of money.**
- 2. The buyer has a real problem.**

Hold both until the buyer's own words prove otherwise. Anything else is you guessing — and guessing only costs you.

THE ASYMMETRIC RISK · WHY THIS BET ONLY WINS**Assume rich → wrong**

Buyer corrects you with a real number. You adjust. Small downside.

Assume rich → right

You pitch confidently. You close at premium tier. Large upside.

Assume broke → wrong

You pitched small. You got a small deal from someone who'd have spent 5x more. Huge downside.

Assume broke → right

You sold a small package. Small upside.

DON'T SAY DUMB THINGS · DON'T THINK THEM EITHER

"Don't say dumb things" is half the rule. The other half — equally important — is don't THINK dumb things. Buyers can hear assumptions through the phone. They can't articulate it. They just react.

THE PRICING BATTLE IS FOUGHT BETWEEN YOUR EARS

Before it's fought on the call. Win it there first.

05 · COUNTER-INTUITIVE

What They Say vs What They Do

The warm buyer is saying goodbye. The cold buyer is buying.

THE WARM BUYER

**Verbally enthusiastic.
Compliments.**

- *"This is wonderful."*
- *"You're brilliant."*
- *"I love what you're doing."*
- *"We might retire soon though..."*

→ **USUALLY A LONG GOODBYE**

THE COLD BUYER

**Flat. Terse.
Price-focused.**

- ◆ *"How much?"*
- ◆ *"What's included?"*
- ◆ *"Let me think about it."*
- ◆ *(quiet — non-committal)*

→ **USUALLY A REAL DEAL**

THE TEST

When a call feels TOO warm — when the buyer is laying on compliments — ask for the next step IMMEDIATELY
I send through the paperwork now?"

Polite buyer: *"Oh, I'll need to think about it..."* → long goodbye.

Real buyer: *"Yeah, send it through."* → deal.

REFERENCE

Daily Card · Keep By the Phone

The whole session on one page.

THE STRUCTURE

- ◆ Floor → CEILING → Likely. Three numbers, in that order.
- ◆ \$340 floor. Up to \$15k ceiling. \$450-650 likely for this buyer.
- ◆ "I don't think it's necessary" — use it 3+ times per pricing call.

THE MINDSET

- ◆ Two pre-call assumptions: rich + has a real problem.
- ◆ Don't pre-judge the wallet. The Lotus dealer lost a six-figure sale doing exactly that.
- ◆ Don't say dumb things — and don't THINK them either.

THE READ

- ◆ Match the buyer's energy. Fast buyer wants fast info.
- ◆ Judge by what they DO — not what they say.
- ◆ Warm buyer = long goodbye. Cold buyer = real deal.

THE BETS

- ◆ Asymmetric: position so being wrong still produces forward motion.
- ◆ Same performance, every audience. Broadway show, not crowd-driven.
- ◆ Same energy, call 1 and call 30. The discipline IS the work.

ANCHOR HIGH · ASSUME ABUNDANCE · DON'T PRE-JUDGE THE WALLET